

Scelidosaurus

The most striking thing about *Scelidosaurus* was its armor. Rows of bony studs and spikes, some as big as a fist, ran from the head to the tail of this plant eater from the Early Jurassic. The armor probably made *Scelidosaurus* a slow mover and forced it to walk on four legs rather than two, but speed wasn't its main defense.



DID YOU KNOW...?

Scelidosaurus was discovered in 1858 by James Harrison, an English quarry worker, and was one of the first dinosaur skeletons found. Encased in hard limestone that was difficult to remove, the bones were largely hidden from view for more than 100 years. In the 1960s, scientists figured out how to dissolve the limestone with acid, and the whole skeleton has now been uncovered.

